

Year 1 Science - Pushes and Pulls

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LEARN IT - SCIENCE IDEA

A push moves an object away from us. A pull moves an object towards us. A force can start, stop or change an object's motion.

Remember: Describe both the force and what happened to the object.

A. GUIDED SCIENCE THINKING

1. Is opening a drawer mainly a push or a pull?

2. What force starts a toy car moving?

3. Name one object that can be both pushed and pulled.

B. INDEPENDENT PRACTICE

1. Circle the pull: closing a door / lifting a zip.

2. Write one playground push.

3. Write one playground pull.

4. A ball is still. What could make it move?

5. A rolling ball stops at a wall. Describe the change.

C. I CAN SHOW MY UNDERSTANDING

Draw an object before and after a push. Add arrows and labels.

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D. INVESTIGATE OR APPLY

Use a safe toy. Give it one gentle push and one gentle pull over the same surface. Observe how its position changes.

My prediction:

What I observed / decided:

E. THINK LIKE A SCIENTIST

1. How were the push and pull alike?

2. What evidence showed that the object moved?

MY LEARNING REVIEW

☐ I can explain it.

☐ I need a little help.

☐ I need more practice.

I understood:

I found this difficult:

PARENT / CARER TIP

Use safe household objects. Ask the child to say: I used a push or pull, and the object...

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COMPLETE ANSWER GUIDE

Guided	Pull; a push; examples include a door, trolley or toy.
Practice	Lifting a zip is a pull; examples vary; a push or pull starts the ball; the wall stops it.
Independent	Drawing shows a clear change in position with a labelled push arrow.
Investigation	Responses vary; observation should describe direction or position, not only say it moved.

TEACHER NOTES - EVIDENCE TO NOTICE

Success evidence: Correctly identifies pushes and pulls and links each force to a change in motion.

Common difficulty: Naming an action without explaining what changed.

Next step: Compare pushes and pulls on objects with wheels and without wheels.

QUICK CONFERENCE RECORD

☐ Secure ☐ Developing ☐ Re-teach

Evidence / next lesson focus:
